

## Chapter 27

# Importing and Organizing Media in the Cut Page

Before you can start editing, you need to import the clips you want to use for your program into the Media Pool, which is the central repository of clips in your project.

This can include video, audio, and graphics files in any format that's supported by DaVinci Resolve.

Once imported, the Media Pool on the Cut page has many organizational tools you can use to make your project's media faster for you to access and sort through as you find the clips you need to create your program.

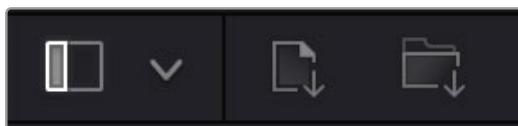
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## Importing Media

Two Import buttons at the top of the Media Pool let you use import dialogs to select media you want to bring into the Media Pool for use in your project.



The Import Media and Import Folder buttons

### To import individual clips:

- 1 Do one of the following:
  - a) Click the Import Media button.
  - b) Press Command-I.
  - c) Right-click the Media Pool and choose Import Media.
- 2 Use the Import dialog to select one or more clips to import, and click Open.
- 3 If you're prompted to change the frame rate of a currently empty project to match that of the incoming media, click Change.

Each piece of media you import, whether it's video, audio, or graphics, appears as an individual clip in the Media Pool. You can also import an entire folder full of media as a bin in the Media Pool.

**To import a folder full of media into a bin:**

- 1 Click the Import Media Folder button.
- 2 Use the Import dialog to select a folder containing media you want to import, and click Open.
- 3 If you're prompted to change the frame rate of a currently empty project to match that of the incoming media, click Change.

Each folder you import appears as a bin in the Media Pool. Double-clicking a bin opens its contents into the Media Pool, enabling you to view each individual clip.

**TIP:** For additional media import features, you can use the Media page, with its Media Storage browser and more feature-rich version of the Media Pool.

## Removing Media

If there are clips you no longer want in your project, you can simply select them and press the Delete or Backspace keys. A Dialog asks if you want to remove the selected clip or clips; clicking Remove will remove them from the Media Pool, while leaving them intact on your media storage device.

If you want to remove every clip in the currently open bin (even the Master bin), you can also right-click anywhere within the Media Pool and choose Remove All Clips in Bin from the contextual menu.

## Organizing Media into Bins

For short projects, having all your clips together in a single bin (the Master bin is the top level of the Media Pool) can be fast. However, for longer projects, organizing your media into subsets of clips within individual bins can make browsing each bin's contents using the Source Tape of the Viewer more manageable.

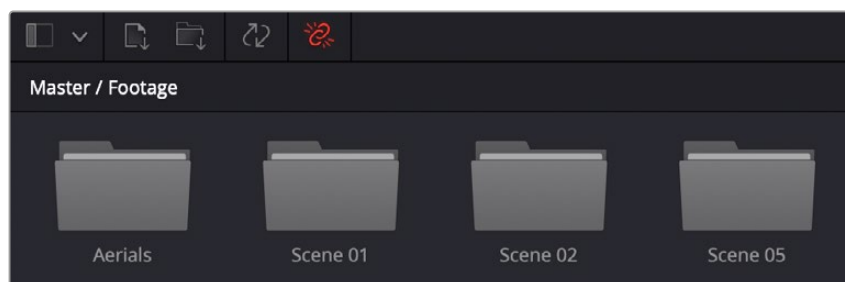
**TIP:** You can move clips you know you don't want, such as instances where the camera rolled on unusable scenery or moments, or completely unusable takes, into another bin so those clips don't present themselves in the Source Tape for bins containing clips you want to use.

### Master Bin

At the top level of your project hierarchy is the Master bin. The Master bin contains all of the media content (clips, timelines, graphics, other bins, etc.) for your project. In the Cut page, the Master bin also shows all of your project's timelines for easy access, regardless of where they've been created in your project.

### Creating and Using Bins

You can create bins with which to organize your media by choosing File > New Bin (Shift-Command-N), or by right-clicking in the Media Pool and choosing New Bin from the contextual menu. You can create bins inside of other bins, and in so doing hierarchically organize the clips you need in a variety of ways.

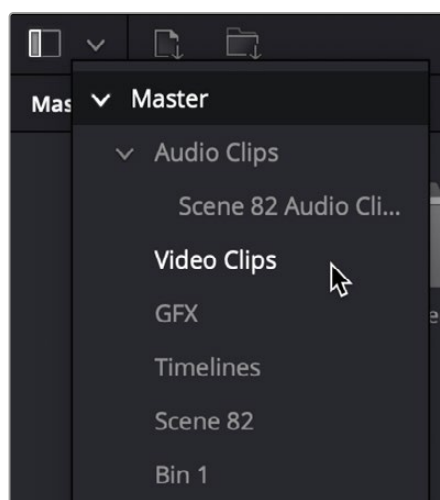


Bins seen in the Media Pool

Once you've created a bin, you can move one or more selected clips into it via drag and drop, just as you would on the desktop of your operating system's file manager.

## Opening Bins

Any visible bin in the Media Pool can be opened by double-clicking it, or by clicking the Bin drop-down at the upper left-hand corner of the Media Pool and choosing a bin to open from the menu (they're shown as a hierarchical list). When opened, a bin's contents fill the Media Pool, and a path indicator at the top of the Media Pool lets you see how many levels deep you are in cases where you have bins inside of bins. You can click any level of this path to jump back up the hierarchy, or you can choose another bin from the Bin drop-down.



The hierarchical Bin drop-down menu

## Create Bin With Selected Clips

You can also create a bin and put clips into it in one step. Select one or more clips in the Media Pool, right-click one of the selected clips, and choose Create Bin With Selected Clips from the contextual menu. A new bin appears called "Bin X" (where X is the next number that's available) displaying the selected clips it now contains.

## Renaming Bins

To rename a bin, click its name once, then slowly click a second time (clicking too fast is a "double-click" which opens the bin), and the name becomes highlighted, ready for editing. You can also right-click a bin and choose Rename Bin from the contextual menu, which also highlights the bin's name, ready for editing. When you're done typing a new name, press Return (or Enter).

## Import and Export Specific DaVinci Resolve Project Bins

You can import/export specific bins from one DaVinci Resolve project to another, allowing you to pass bins quickly between projects and workstations that have access to the same media. All Metadata, In/Out points, Timelines, etc. are transferred along with the clips in the bin, but none of the actual media files are included.

### To export bins from the Media Pool:

- 1 Select one or more bins in the Media Pool.
- 2 Right-click the selection and choose “Export Bin,” or choose File > Export > Export Bin.
- 3 Choose where to save the DaVinci Resolve Bin file (.drb) in the file system dialog, and click Save.

### To import bins into the Media Pool:

- 1 Right-click in the Media Pool and choose “Import Bin,” or choose File > Import > Import Bin.
- 2 Do one of the following:
  - Choose a DaVinci Resolve Bin file (.drb) from the file system dialog.
  - Double click the .drb file in your file system.

The bin or bins will appear in the Media Pool. Any bins imported this way will have the word “import” appended to their name, to avoid duplicate names. If you import a bin that contains clips that were already in the Media Pool, the potentially duplicate clips are excluded from the import and instead relinked to the media referenced by your project. This keeps your Media Pool tidy. However, if the bin or bins have been moved to another computer, you may have to relink offline media.

## Import and Export Individual DaVinci Resolve Timelines

You can export and import individual timelines from one DaVinci Resolve project into another previously existing DaVinci Resolve project, allowing you to pass timelines quickly between projects and workstations, without creating additional imported project files. Just the timeline and its associated clip information is exported, none of the actual media files are included.

### To export a timeline from the Media Pool:

- 1 Select a timeline from the Media Pool.
- 2 Choose File > Export > Export AAF, XML, DRT (Shift-Command-O).
- 3 Choose “DaVinci Resolve Timeline Files (\*.drt)” from the format options drop-down in the file system dialog.
- 4 Choose where to save the DaVinci Resolve Timeline file (.drt) in the file system dialog, and click Save.

### To import a timeline into the Media Pool:

- 1 Choose a bin in the Media Pool in which you want the imported timeline to be saved.
- 2 Do one of the following:
  - Choose File > Import Timeline > Import AAF, XML, DRT (Shift-Command-I), then Select a DaVinci Resolve Timeline file (.drt) from the file system dialog, and click Open.
  - Double click the .drt file in your file system.

The timeline will appear in the Media Pool, along with all of the clips associated with it. Any timelines imported this way will have the word “import” appended to their name, to avoid duplicate names. The imported timeline will be automatically conformed to corresponding media that’s already in the Media Pool. However, if the timeline has been moved to another computer, you may have to reimport or relink missing or offline media in to bring the imported timeline fully online.

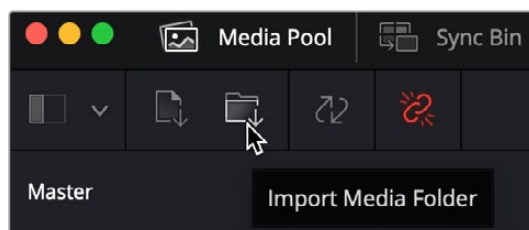
**NOTE:** Only a single timeline can be imported and exported at a time using this method. To import or export multiple timelines, use the Import/Export Bin function described above.

## Sync Media Pool Bins with File System Folders

You can now sync a Media Pool bin with a folder on your computer's file system (MacOS, Windows, Linux etc.). This allows you to add additional media into a folder on your computer and have it automatically import to its respective bin in DaVinci Resolve.

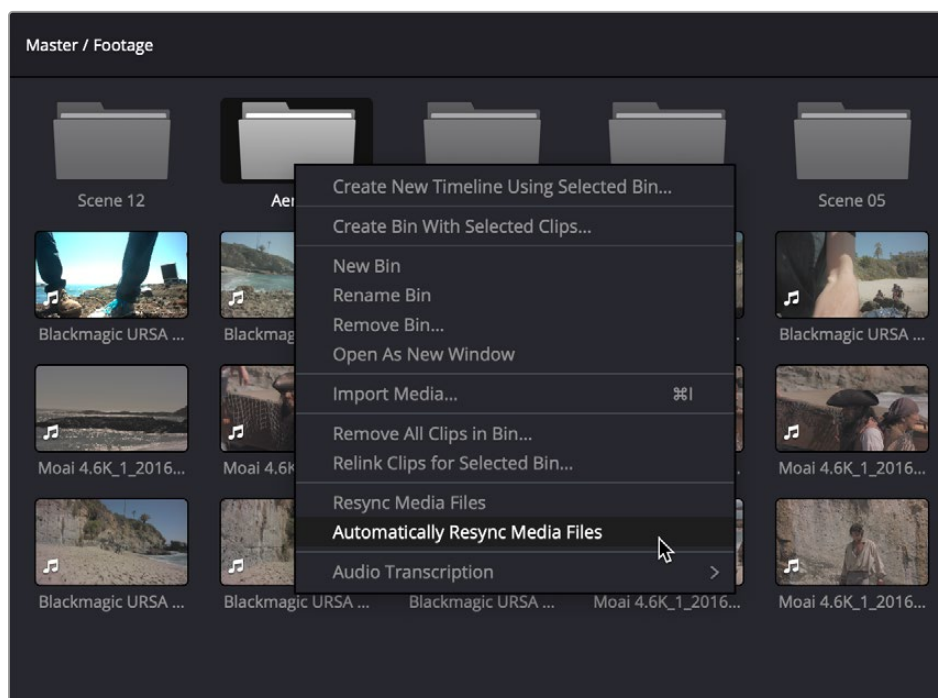
### To set up a folder with Automatic Syncing:

- 1 On the Cut page, use the Import Folder icon on the top menu bar to set up matching folder and sub folder names.



Use the Import Media Folder icon in the Cut page

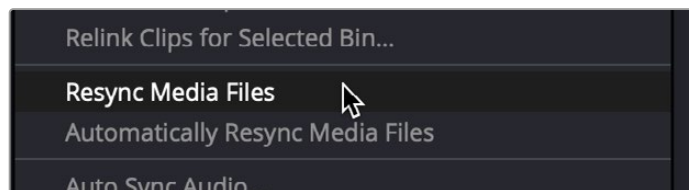
- 2 Right-click on the imported folder and choose "Automatically Resync Media Files."



Right-click on the bin and select Automatically Resync Media Files

Newly added clips in this folder will be added automatically to the media bin. This can be useful when working with cloud-synced media files (as when using DaVinci Resolve's Replay capabilities), or any files that may be added to the folder later.

To manually resync the contents of a Media Pool bin once, right-click a bin and choose "Resync Media Files."



Right-click on the bin and select Resync Media Files to perform the sync operation manually.

**For both Resync actions, ensure that:**

- At least one clip is present in the media bin.
- All existing clips in the media bin share the same file path.
- The media bin name matches the parent folder of the clip paths. You can ensure this is set up correctly by using "Import Media Folder" in the Cut page, or "Add Folder and SubFolders into Media Pool (Create Bins)" in the Media page.

Sync actions will add new clips from sub-folders if the corresponding sub-bins exist. However, newly created sub-folders without corresponding media bins are not tracked, and new media bins without the corresponding sub-folders are skipped.

For example, say you were editing a sporting event, and you had a graphics operator creating animated lower-thirds for each of the players. By creating a common network folder called "CG" and automatically syncing it in DaVinci Resolve, each time a new lower-third was finished and saved, it would automatically appear in your bin in the Media Pool, ready for use.

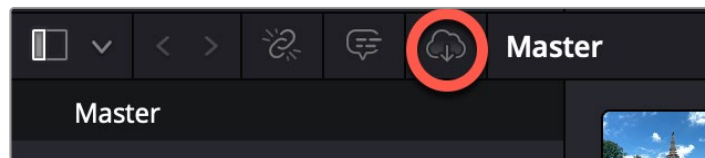
**Here's how you would set this up:**

- Create a folder on your network storage called "CG." Both the editor and the graphics operator need to have access to this folder.
- Note that because this folder is currently empty, it can not be used in a Resync action yet. Only after there is at least one media file in the folder can you perform a Resync.
- The graphics operator finishes his first animated lower third and saves it to the "CG" folder as a .mov file (though any DaVinci Resolve readable media format would work).
- The editor then imports the "CG" folder into the Media Pool in DaVinci Resolve and selects Automatically Resync Media Files from the context menu.
- As the graphics operator finishes and saves additional lower thirds into that folder, they automatically appear in the Editor's "CG" bin in the Media Pool, without having to specifically import them.
- For organizational purposes, the graphics operator then creates a new folder in "CG" for the other team, called "Team B." Unfortunately, because this folder structure was not in the original imported bin, it does not show up in the editor's media pool. However if they had created this Team B folder before the editor imported it, and it had media in it, it would be there.
- Now in this case, the editor simply imports the same bin again, selects Automatically Resync Media Files, and the new folder and all its media appear as expected. Any further files in dropped in "Team B" will show up in the editor's media pool.

**IMPORTANT:** Media entries for clips that are removed or not found on the file system are set as offline media. This allows for retention of metadata and is useful when the clip path is temporarily offline, on cloud storage where file status may be in flux, or moved away by apps or workflows seeking to write a new version in its place.

## Import Blackmagic Cloud Shared Folders to Media Pool

You can now import and sync Blackmagic Cloud Folders into the Media Pool. This allows you to connect to one or more cloud media folders and selectively download media from them to your local machine. Blackmagic Cloud Folders are online common storage folders that are not tied to a specific project. This lets you create a pool of commonly used media assets, such as title sequences, credits, bumpers etc, and share them online without having to import them separately into each individual project.



The Import Cloud Folder icon at the top of the Media Pool

### To link a Blackmagic Cloud Folder to your project:

- 1 Sign into your Blackmagic Cloud account in DaVinci Resolve.
- 2 Click on the Import Blackmagic Cloud Folder icon at the top of the Media Pool in any page.
- 3 In the Blackmagic Cloud Folder dialog, click select to choose a Blackmagic Cloud Folder. The choices here will show any Blackmagic Cloud Folder that you have created or someone else has shared with you. Click the Add button.
- 4 In the Download Folder Location, select a file location on your local system that you want the media from the Blackmagic Cloud Folder to be stored in.
- 5 Choose whether you want to sync proxies only, or proxies and used originals.
- 6 Press Download to add the Cloud Folder to your Media Pool.

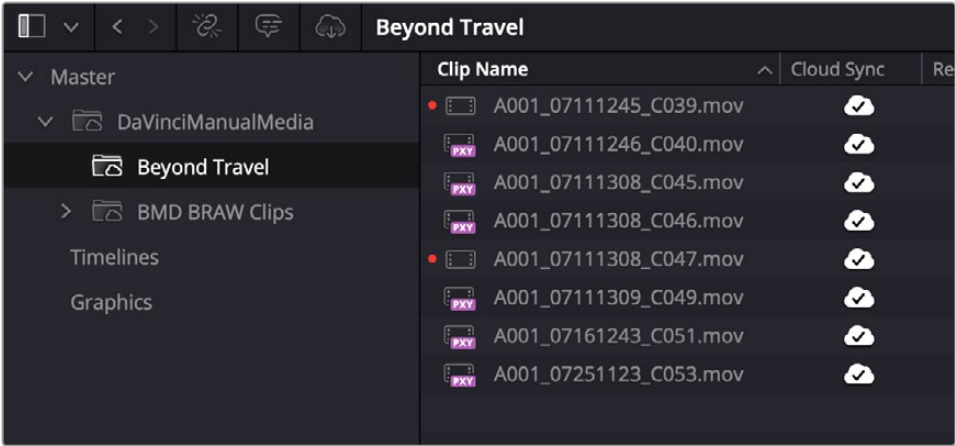


The Blackmagic Cloud Folder link dialog



When you open the Blackmagic Cloud Folder in the Media Pool, it will be empty and populate one clip at a time as their clip names (not their media) are downloaded from the cloud. Also the Blackmagic Cloud Folder is not actually linked to your project yet; it is only linked when the first media clip is “used.”

A “used” clip is new terminology in DaVinci Resolve and simply means a clip that has been altered in any way inside the project. A clip can be used by putting it on a timeline certainly, but also includes other actions like applying a flag, altering its metadata, transcribing it, etc. Once a clip is used, its media will start to download to your local machine. Clips that are used are denoted by a red dot next to them in the Media Pool. Any unused clips will remain as virtual clips in the Cloud Folder until used. Once downloaded, clips in Cloud Folders can be used just like any other clip in the Media Pool.



The Cloud Folder linked in List view. Clips with red dots are “used” and the original media has been downloaded. Unused clips have just their proxies available to view. The Cloud Sync column shows that the media is registered and synced with the Blackmagic Cloud.

# ATEM Switcher Integration

If you’ve recorded a multi-camera event with the ATEM Mini Pro ISO or ATEM Mini Extreme ISO, it is possible to move that entire project into DaVinci Resolve. ATEM projects include the master program clip, as well as each individual camera’s “ISO” (isolated) clips, and each camera angle’s audio recordings. All transitions, timecode, and camera number metadata are imported, as well as whatever graphics were stored in the ATEM’s Media Pool. Once the project is loaded, you can seamlessly continue your multi-camera edit in the Cut page.

This initial live recording coupled with later post-production editing workflow is often referred to as “Live to Tape.” Live to Tape gives you the all the benefits of the spontaneity, verisimilitude, and fast turnaround inherent to live production but with the added benefit of being able to later add and remove sections and adjust the editorial flow of the program. Live to Tape also allows you to fix simple mistakes, such as choosing a better camera angle, or replacing a title or graphic with an updated version. Because of this flexibility, Live to Tape is the preferred method of recording almost all broadcast network game shows, current events shows, and sitcoms. Essentially, any type of multi-camera production that does not primarily depend on being live in real time for its main purpose (like news or sports) is shot Live to Tape instead.

The Live to Tape workflow requires the following elements, all of which are provided by the ATEM Mini Pro ISO and ATEM Mini Extreme ISO.

- A program master clip that was shot live, including all the mixed camera angles, audio, transitions, etc. from the beginning of the show until the end, for reference.
- Separate ISO recordings from each camera used to shoot the program master clip. An ISO is an isolated (ISO) camera recording of the entire show from that camera's perspective only, from the beginning to end and without interruption.
- A timeline of the live recorded show that indicates where all the camera angles were switched, what transitions were used, and what graphics were involved.

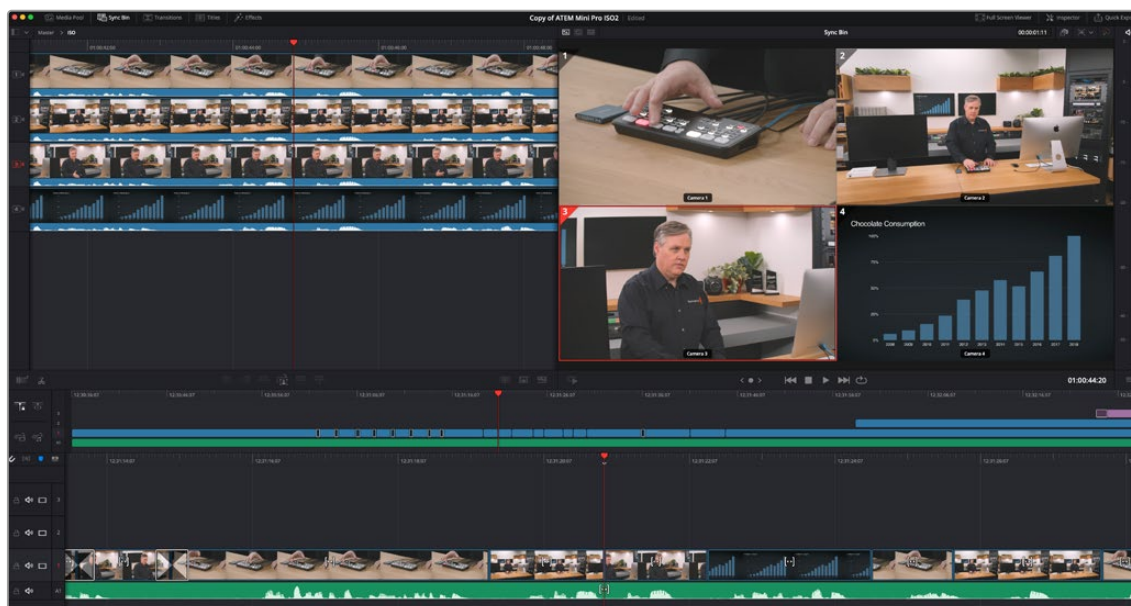
## Importing ATEM Mini Pro ISO Projects

Importing an ATEM project essentially rebuilds the master program clip as a timeline inside DaVinci Resolve from the camera ISOs, transitions, and graphics. This new timeline will match the master program clip in every way, just created from the original source materials rather than as a single compressed video file.

Refer to your ATEM's specific documentation for how to set up ISO recording, but one important setting is to make sure that you've checked the "ISO Record All Inputs" setting in the ATEM software control before you start shooting.

### To import an ATEM Mini Pro ISO Project:

- 1 (Before you shoot) Check the "ISO Record All Inputs" setting in the ATEM software control.
- 2 At this point, record your show using the ATEM device, and note the project's folder location.
- 3 Select File > Import Project.
- 4 Select the DaVinci Resolve Project file (.drp) in the ATEM project folder, in the file browser.
- 5 Click on the Open button.



An ATEM Mini Pro project opened in the Cut page Sync bin

## Relinking Blackmagic Camera Masters to ATEM ISOs

The ATEM records each camera's ISO as an H.264 HD video stream, which may not be of high enough resolution or quality for some purposes. It's possible to instantly switch your ATEM camera ISOs to the original camera recordings made in a Blackmagic Camera instead. This workflow enables the highest visual quality of Blackmagic RAW and the ability to output in higher resolutions (such as 4K or UHD) than are supported by the ATEM internally. Essentially, the ATEM can reference an additional set of higher quality ISOs recorded in the cameras, rather than those from the ATEM itself. This feature is only available using Blackmagic Cameras.

This workflow requires one more step in the process, namely making sure that you have sufficient recording space attached to each camera to record the show in its entirety. Refer to your ATEM's specific documentation for how to set up ISO recording and camera control, but one important setting is to make sure that you've checked the "ISO Record All Inputs" and the "Record in All Cameras" settings in the ATEM software control before you start shooting.

### To relink to Blackmagic Camera masters from ATEM ISO recordings:

- 1 (Before you shoot) Check the "Record in All Cameras" setting in the ATEM software control.
- 2 (Before you shoot) Check the "ISO Record All Inputs" setting in the ATEM software control.
- 3 At this point, record your show using the ATEM device and note the project's folder location.
- 4 Copy all the resulting camera masters from each camera's memory card to the ATEM project's "Video ISO Files" folder, and then import the project into DaVinci Resolve.
- 5 DaVinci Resolve automatically creates a separate Blackmagic RAW folder in your project and moves all the camera masters to that folder.
- 6 Use the menu Timeline > Switch to Camera Originals to instantly switch between referencing the ATEM H.264 ISOs and the Blackmagic Camera masters.



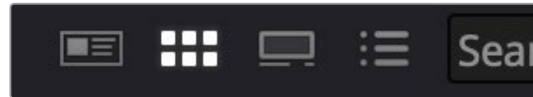
The Show Camera Originals button

Once your project is imported successfully into DaVinci Resolve, it can be edited using the variety of specialized Multicam editing tools found in the Cut page, including the Sync Bin, Live Overwrite, and the DaVinci Resolve Speed Editor.

For more information on using these tools, see *Chapter 28, "Fast Editing in the Cut Page."*

# Media Pool Views

Once you've imported some clips into the Media Pool, three controls at the upper right-hand side let you control how they look, depending on what you need to accomplish.



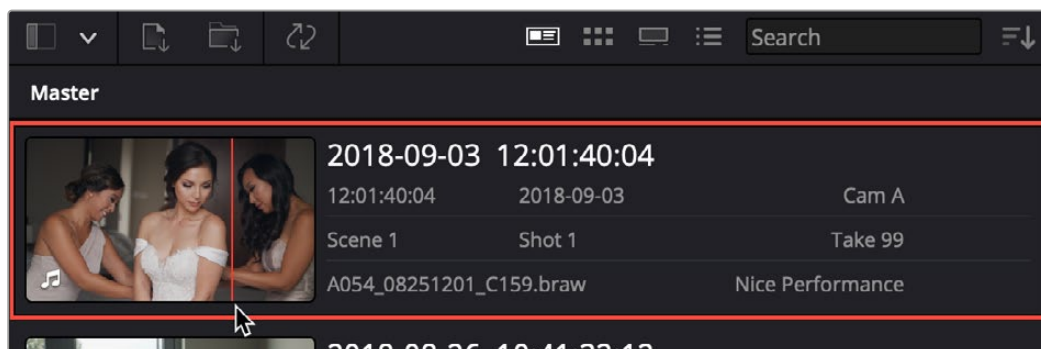
The View Mode buttons

## Metadata View

In the Metadata view mode, each clip is represented by its own card with a thumbnail and basic clip metadata information visible. This view is designed to have more metadata information than a thumbnail but more targeted information than the List view. This feature, combined with its sort modes, is a powerful way to organize and reorganize your clips in the Media Pool.

### The metadata fields of the Metadata view (from the top down):

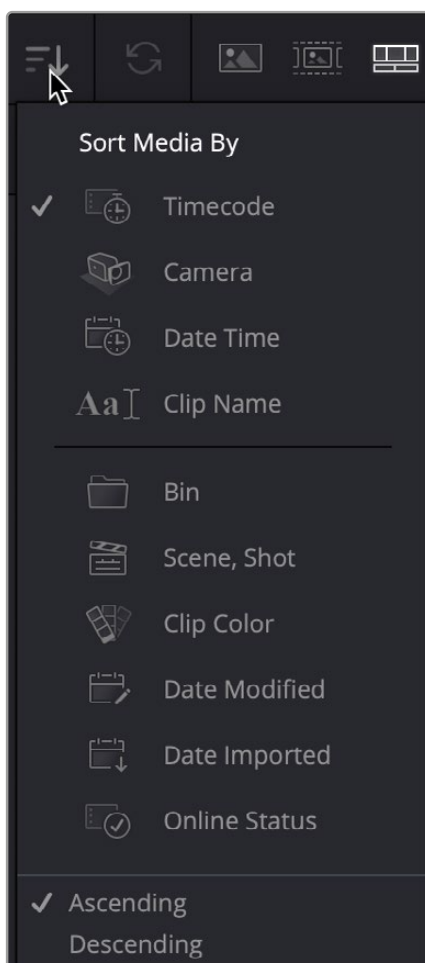
- **Thumbnail:** A scrubbable thumbnail image of your clip.
- **Row 1:** A main description field that is variable and determined by the sort order selection.
- **Row 2:** Start Timecode, Date Created, Camera #.
- **Row 3:** Scene, Shot, Take.
- **Row 4:** Clip Name, Comment.



The Metadata View icon view (highlighted icon in the top bar), showing the thumbnail being scrubbed next to the clip's metadata

The strength of the Metadata view is the automatic clustering of your clips in the Source Tape, based on the sort order you choose in the Media Pool Sort By menu at the very upper-right corner of the Media Pool. It is also possible to use these sort options in the Thumbnail, List, and Filmstrip views as well.

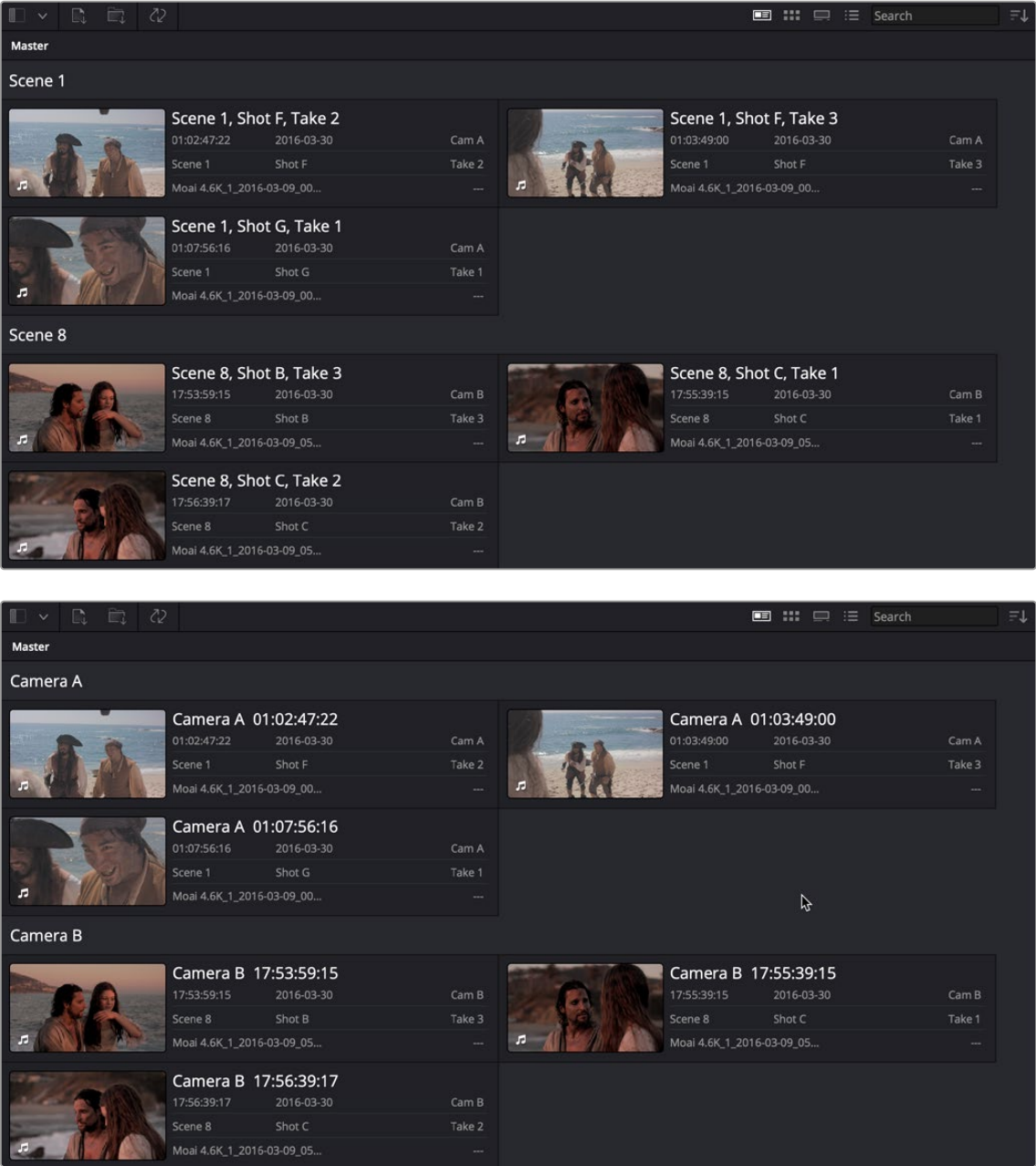
The sort modes available in the Metadata view are:



The Media Sort options

- **Timecode:** This mode clusters the clips by creation date, changes the main description field to creation date and start timecode, and orders the list by timecode.
- **Camera:** This mode clusters the clips by Camera #, changes the main description field to camera # and start timecode, and orders the list by timecode.
- **Date Time:** This mode clusters the clips by day, changes the main description field to creation date and file name, and orders the list by timecode.
- **Clip Name:** This mode clusters the clips by the first letter of the clip name in alphabetical order, changes the main description field to clip name, and orders the list by timecode.
- **Bin:** This mode clusters the clips by bin, changes the main description field to clip name, and orders the list by timecode.
- **Scene, Shot:** This mode clusters the clips by scene, changes the main description field to scene-shot-take, and orders the list by scene-shot-take.
- **Clip Color:** This mode clusters the clips by clip color name, changes the main description field to creation date and start timecode, and orders the list by timecode.
- **Date Modified:** This mode clusters the clips by day, changes the main description field to creation date and file name, and orders the list by the last time the clip was modified by the OS filesystem.
- **Date Imported:** This mode clusters the clips by day, changes the main description field to creation date and file name, and orders the list by the date the clip was added to the Media Pool.
- **Online Status:** This mode clusters the clips by proxy or original status.
- **Ascending:** Orders the Media Pool from lowest numerical value to highest, and alphabetically from A to Z.
- **Descending:** Orders the Media Pool from highest numerical value to lowest, and alphabetically from Z to A.

Each different sort mode changes the main description field on the card and re-arranges the Source Tape to reflect the selected organization method.

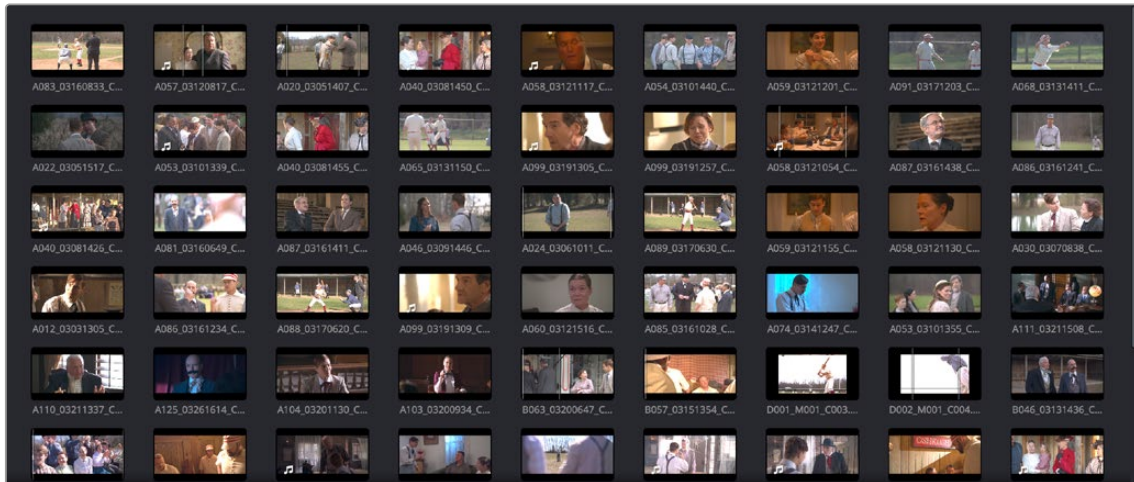


(Top) The Metadata view with clips sorted by Scene-Shot-Take  
(Bottom) The Metadata view with the same clips sorted by Camera



## Thumbnail View

Each clip is represented by a scrubbable thumbnail. Hover the playhead over each thumbnail and move it left and right to see the clip's image play, and use the I and O keys to mark sections of a clip that you want to use. Hover scrub can be enabled and disabled using the Media Pool option menu on the Edit page.



The Icon View mode

## Filmstrip View

Each clip is represented by a filmstrip of consecutive frames the length of the Media Pool. Hover the playhead over the clip and move it left and right to see the clip's image play, and use the I and O keys to mark sections of a clip that you want to use.



The Filmstrip View mode

## List View

Each clip appears as an item in a multi-column list showing a variety of metadata about each clip. In list view, you can click the header of any column to sort the contents by that column's information (clicking again toggles the sort order between Ascending and Descending). Scrolling right reveals additional columns of information. Clicking on an item on the list may let you change its value, depending on the column.

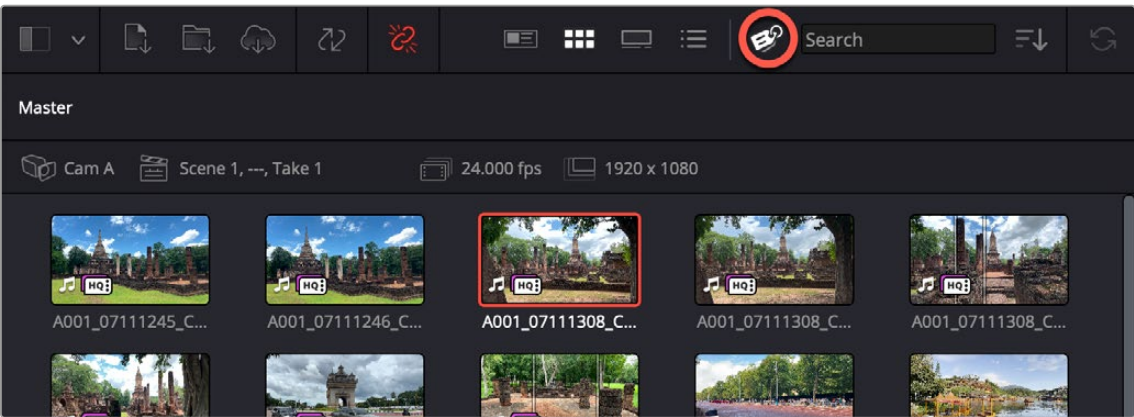
Master / Footage / Scene 01

| Start:TC    | ^ | Date Created             | Clip Name   | Cloud Sync | Camera # | Scene | Shot | Take | Clip Color | Online Status | Date Modified            | Date |
|-------------|---|--------------------------|-------------|------------|----------|-------|------|------|------------|---------------|--------------------------|------|
| 01:00:08:02 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:36:36 | > 01F_MS_01 |            | A        | 01F   | MS   | 01   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:36:36 | Wed  |
| 01:02:47:22 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:37:06 | > 01F_MS_01 |            | A        | 01F   | MS   | 01   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:37:06 | Wed  |
| 01:03:49:00 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:37:32 | > 01F_MS_02 |            | A        | 01F   | MS   | 02   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:37:32 | Wed  |
| 01:07:56:16 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:38:05 | ▼ 01G_MS_01 |            | A        | 01G   | MS   | 01   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:38:05 | Wed  |
| 01:07:57:23 |   |                          | SLATE       |            | A        | 01G   | MS   | 01   |            |               |                          |      |
| 01:24:31:12 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:39:03 | > 01H_WS_01 |            | A        | 01H   | WS   | 01   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:39:03 | Wed  |
| 01:27:58:08 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:39:39 | > 01H_WS_02 |            | A        | 01H   | WS   | 02   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:39:39 | Wed  |
| 01:30:50:19 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:40:07 | > 01J_WS_01 |            | A        | 01J   | WS   | 01   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:40:07 | Wed  |
| 01:31:48:15 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:40:40 | > 01J_WS_02 |            | A        | 01J   | WS   | 02   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:40:40 | Wed  |
| 01:33:35:10 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:41:41 | > 01J_WS_03 |            | A        | 01J   | WS   | 03   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:41:41 | Wed  |
| 01:36:02:13 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:42:18 | > 01K_WS_01 |            | A        | 01K   | WS   | 01   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:42:18 | Wed  |
| 01:38:03:22 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:42:49 | > 01K_WS_02 |            | A        | 01K   | WS   | 02   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:42:49 | Wed  |
| 01:39:51:07 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:43:29 | > 01K_MS_03 |            | A        | 01K   | MS   | 03   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:43:29 | Wed  |
| 01:43:44:05 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:44:15 | > 01M_WS_01 |            | A        | 01M   | WS   | 01   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:44:15 | Wed  |
| 01:47:09:08 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:44:37 | > 01M_WS_02 |            | A        | 01M   | WS   | 02   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:44:37 | Wed  |
| 01:49:19:02 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:45:21 | > 01N_MS_01 |            | A        | 01N   | MS   | 01   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:45:21 | Wed  |
| 01:50:42:13 |   | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:45:49 | > 01N_MS_02 |            | A        | 01N   | MS   | 02   |            | Original      | Tue Mar 29 2016 22:45:49 | Wed  |

The List View mode

## Metadata Display Palette

When in the Source Tape or Source mode in the Viewer, a small tag icon becomes available directly to the left of the search bar in the Media Pool. Clicking on this icon activates the Metadata Display palette at the top of the Media Pool. The display shows basic information about whatever clip is selected in order for you to quickly review the details about selected clips.



Next to the search bar in the Cut page Media Pool, is a small tag icon (circled red) that opens the Metadata display panel at the top of the Media Pool.

**The information on the display includes:** Camera Name, Scene/Shot/Take, Frame Rate, and Resolution.



# Sorting and Searching

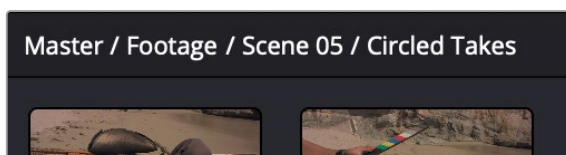
Once you've imported media into your project, searching and sorting controls help you find what you need.

## Searching

A search field lets you type a term you want to use to find one or more clips that match that criteria. When you type anything, the contents of the Media Pool shrink to show only clips that match your criteria.

## Navigable Clip Paths

The Media Pool in the Cut page has a navigable title bar that shows a clip's Media Pool hierarchy. As you navigate in the Media Pool, the current clip is highlighted, and its hierarchy will now appear in top of the Media Pool title bar. By clicking directly on bins in this bin path, you can quickly broaden or narrow the scope of the Media Pool, say from Shoot Day to Camera to Card to Clip and vice versa.



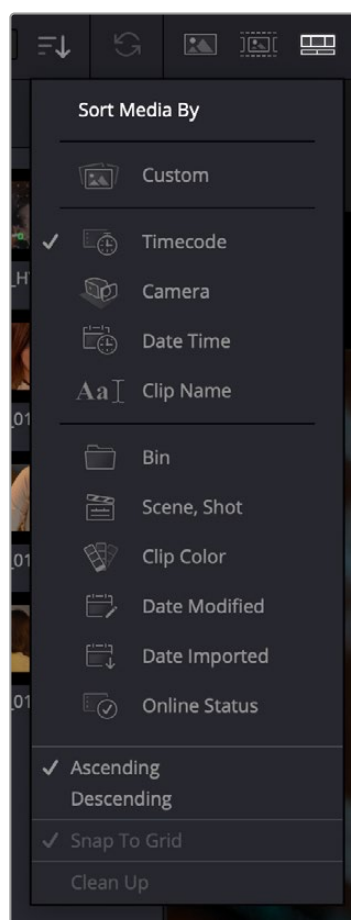
The Media Pool title bar showing a clip's Media Pool hierarchy. Clicking directly on these bins will narrow or broaden the scope of the clips in the Source tape.

## Sort Media By

A Sort Media By drop-down menu lets you choose which criteria defines the order in which clips in the Media Pool are arranged. Options include: Custom, Timecode, Camera, Date Time, Clip Name, Bin, Scene Shot, Clip Color, Date Modified, Date Imported, and Online Status, and you can choose to sort in Ascending (bottom to top) or Descending (top to bottom) order.

Lastly, a search field lets you type a term you want to use to find one or more clips that match that criteria. When you type anything, the contents of the Media Pool shrink to show only clips that match your criteria.

**TIP:** If you want to sort by a criteria that's not in the drop-down menu, you can switch the Media Pool to List view, then sort by any column you might want (such as "Date Created"), and then switch back to Icon or Filmstrip view.



The Media Pool Sort options

## Finding Timeline Clips in the Media Pool

From time to time, you'll find yourself wanting to find the source clip in the Media Pool that corresponds to a clip in the Timeline. For example, you might want to go back to a part of an interview clip you've already used to find another phrase on the same topic.

### To find a timeline clip in the Media Pool:

- Right-click a clip in the Timeline, and choose Find in Media Pool from the contextual menu. The corresponding clip is selected in the Media Pool, which scrolls to show that clip, if necessary.
- If you have several clips that are synced, right-click a clip in the Timeline, and choose Find in Multi Source from the contextual menu. The corresponding clip is selected in the Media Pool and opened in the Multi Source Viewer, which allows you to choose another camera angle of the same shot.

## Clip Color

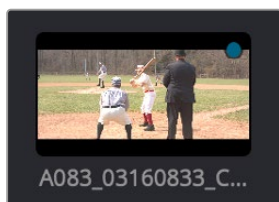
Clip colors are an organizational tool that make it easier to keep track of different kinds of clips visually. For example, you can assign colors based on good takes, based on characters or subjects in the program, based on type of media (b-roll versus a-roll for example), or using any one of a number of organizational strategies. Whatever helps you keep track of things you need to keep track of.

### Changing clip colors:

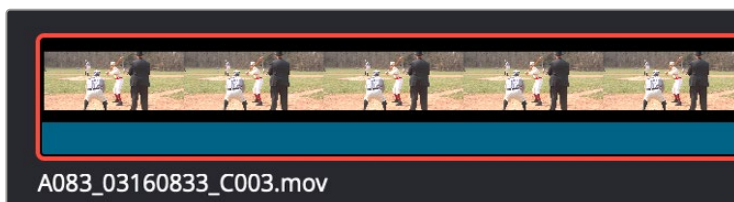
- You can assign colors to clips by right-clicking one or more selected clips in the Media Pool or Timeline, and choosing one of 16 available colors from the Clip Color submenu of the contextual menu.

### Removing clip colors:

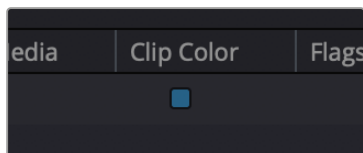
- Clip colors can be removed by right-clicking one or more selected clips in the Media Pool or Timeline, and choosing Clear Color from the Clip Color submenu of the contextual menu.
- Clip colors appear as a colored dot on a clip thumbnail when in Thumbnail view, as a clip color in Filmstrip view, and as a patch in the Clip Color column when in Column view.



Clip color in – Thumbnail

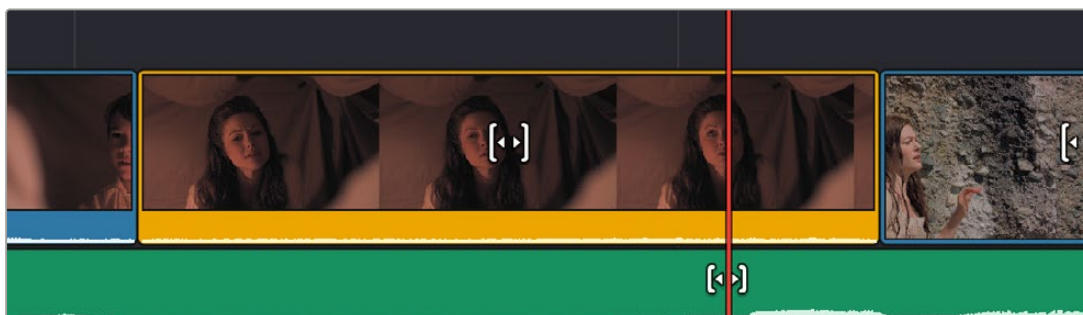


Clip color in – Filmstrip



Clip color in – Column views

- Clips with assigned colors also appear tinted in the Timeline, similarly to the Filmstrip tint in the Media Pool.



A timeline with a video clip that has been colored to identify what they are to the editor

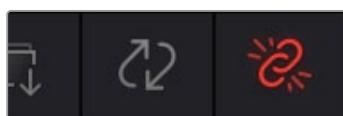
## Relinking Media

DaVinci Resolve attempts to automatically keep track of the relationship between clips in your project and their corresponding source media on disk. If, for whatever reason, source media that links to clips in your project becomes unavailable because it's been moved, DaVinci Resolve has several different methods of relinking those clips in the Media Pool. This section summarizes two methods of relinking, "Relink Media" and the "Relink selected clips" command.

For more information on other methods of conforming projects and relinking media, see *Chapter 56, "Conforming and Relinking Clips."*

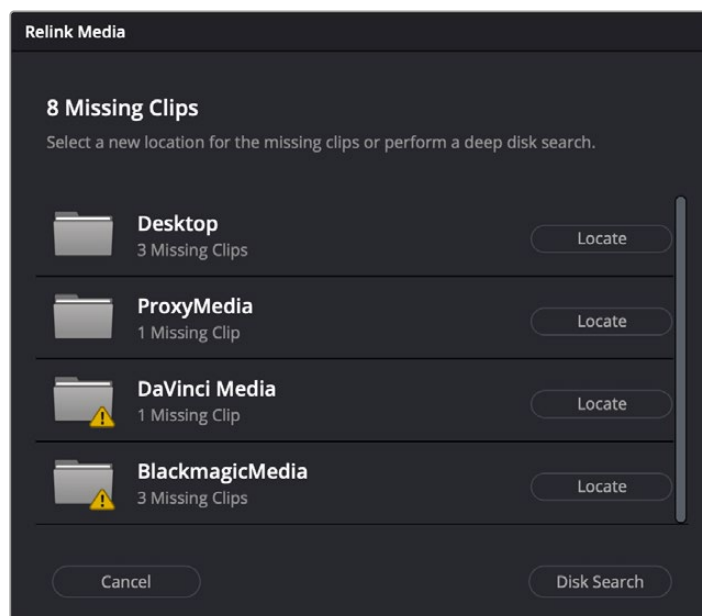
### Relink Media

If DaVinci Resolve fails to find your media, a Relink Media icon in the Cut page's and Edit page's Media Pools will highlight orange.



The Relink Media icon that appears for unlinked media

Clicking this icon opens a dialog box showing the volumes that the missing files initially belonged to. You can then use this information to track down the media on your file system, find that specific hard drive, or ask a client if they provided you the media from this volume. Clicking the Locate button lets you re-connect the missing clips to a new file location of your choosing. If the quick search initiated by the Locate buttons doesn't find media that you know is there, you can initialize an exhaustive deep disk search for the media by clicking on the Disk Search button.



The Relink Media dialog showing the volume names where the missing clips originated

## Relink Selected Clips

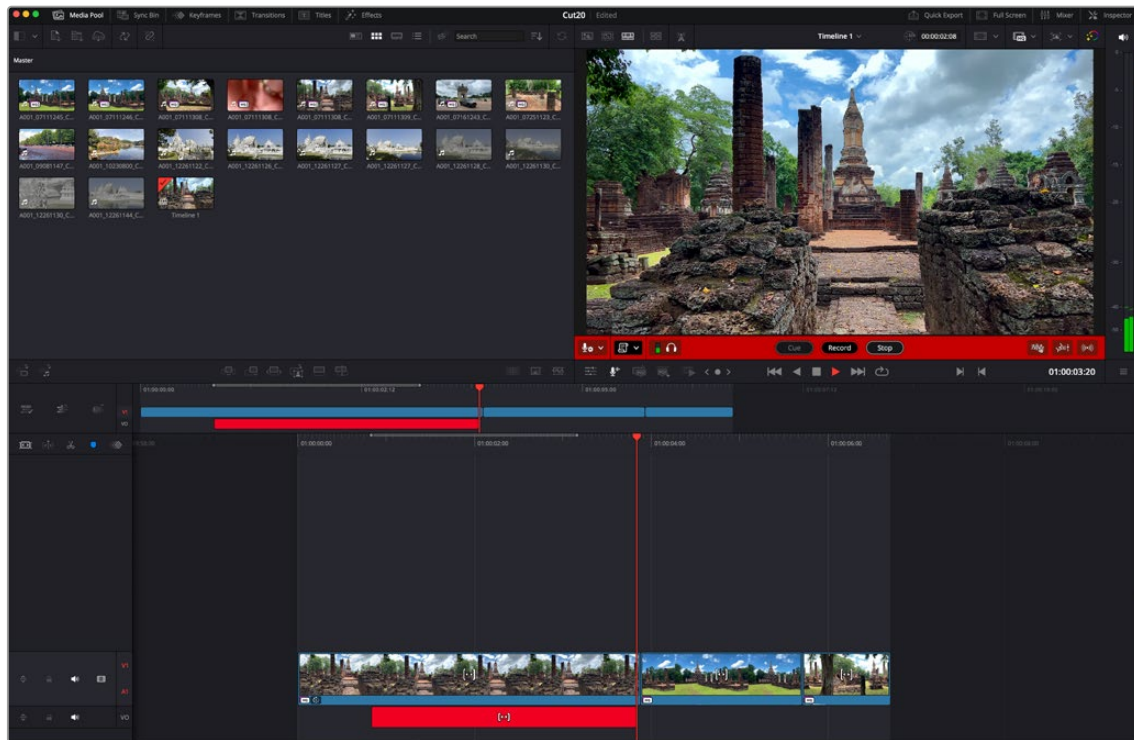
The appropriately named “Relink selected clips” command is the most flexible method of relinking clips in your project with clips in a directory of your choice, using file name and timecode as the primary criteria for reconnecting the relationship between each clip and its corresponding media file on disk.

### To relink selected clips or clips in a selected bin:

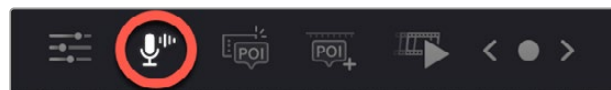
- 1 Do one of the following:
  - Select one or more clips in the Media Pool browser that you want to relink, then right-click one of the selected clips or the selected bin, and choose “Relink Selected Clips” from the contextual menu.
  - Select a bin in the Media Pool bin drop-down menu that contains clips you want to relink, then right-click the selected bin and choose “Relink Clips for Selected Bin” from the contextual menu.
- 2 When the Relink File dialog opens, choose a volume and directory in which to look for the files you want to relink to, and click OK. DaVinci Resolve attempts to find every clip with a matching file name in the subdirectories of the directory you chose, using the original file paths of the clips being relinked to do this as quickly as possible. By first looking for the clips in the directories they were originally in, relinking can be quite fast.
- 3 If there are any clips that couldn’t be found using the method in step 2, you’re prompted with the option to do a “deep search” by a second dialog. If you click Yes, then DaVinci Resolve will look for each clip inside every subdirectory of the directory you selected in step 2. This may take significantly longer, but it should be completely successful so long as the media that’s required is within the selected directory structure.
- 4 If there are still other clips that couldn’t be found, you’re prompted to either choose another directory altogether to continue searching, or quit.

# Voiceover Tool

The Cut page in DaVinci Resolve has a dedicated voiceover and teleprompter interface, easily accessible in the Viewer by clicking on the Voiceover icon. The Voiceover tool makes it simple to record perfectly timed scripts directly into the Cut page timeline. You can even apply Voice Isolation and the Dialog Leveler on the fly to get great results, even with substandard microphones and recording environments.



Recording a VO audio track directly into the Cut Page timeline using the Voiceover tool



The Voiceover icon (red) opens the Voiceover toolset

## Using Voiceover on the Cut Page

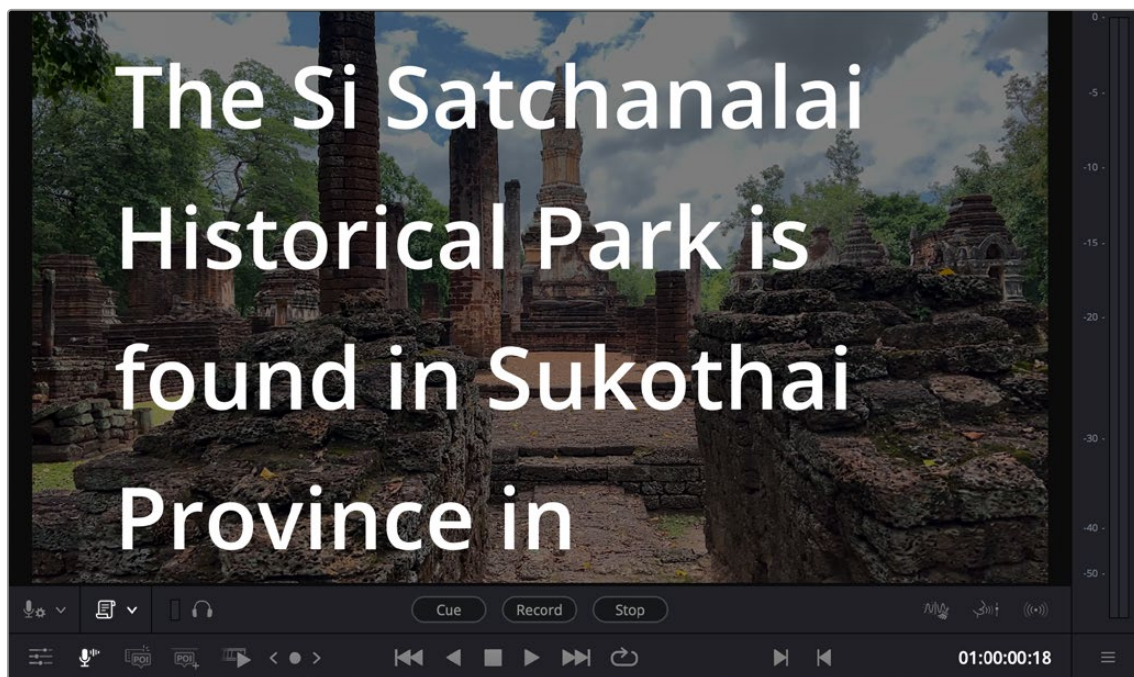
At its most basic, you can quickly “punch in” a recording using only a microphone and an In point, but the Voiceover tool has a variety of features to make the process more precise and repeatable, including teleprompter support and AI-based audio tools. Below is a sample setup that makes the most out of the Voiceover features on the Cut page.

- 1 Connect an external microphone and headphones to your computer, then format a plain text (.txt) script for your VO.
- 2 Press the Voiceover tool icon in the Viewer.
- 3 In the Voiceover settings, select your microphone interface.
- 4 Select the Audio Track you want the voiceover clip to be recorded to. By default, the Cut page creates a new track called VO.

- 5 You have additional options for countdowns and to select the file folder that your voice recordings are saved into.
- 6 Determine where in the timeline this voiceover is needed. In a simple setup, just place the playhead at the location you want the VO to start. You can also set an In point in the timeline to serve as a cue point that the Voiceover tool returns to for subsequent takes.
- 7 You can optionally turn on the Voice Isolation and Dialog Leveler, if you're recording in a substandard audio environment (for example, directly into your laptop microphone in an office environment) to clean up your audio as you record it.
- 8 Click the Record button to start the teleprompter and recording to the selected track. The interface will change to red to let you know you're "on the air."
- 9 Click Stop to end the recording. The playhead will automatically snap back to your start position, so you can then play your new voiceover in place.
- 10 If you need to try again, press the Cue button to automatically return to the In point, and press Record again to give it another take. The new voiceover will automatically overwrite the old take on the timeline. However, all of your previous VO takes will still be saved in the Media Pool, if you want to go back to them.

## Using the Prompter

The Voiceover tool has a built in Prompter toolset that lets you import a text (.txt) script, and during recording the text scrolls over the picture for accurate voiceover performance and placement.



The built-in Prompter in the Voiceover tool

### To use the Prompter while recording voice over:

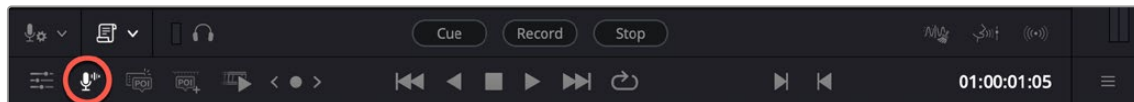
- 1 Open and set up the Voice Over tool as described above.
- 2 In the Script Settings, enable the Prompter Overlay, and load the Script File. You have additional settings for how the script is formatted in the Viewer.



- 3 You can set In and Out points on the timeline to mark the VO range for the teleprompter. The teleprompter will then adjust its speed automatically to start scrolling at the In point, and end at the Out point. By default, the script scroll length will cover the entire timeline if no In or Out points are set.
- 4 When you press record, the text will scroll over the image while your voice over is being recorded.

## Voiceover Settings

The Voiceover tool has several optional settings to fine tune your VO session.



Clicking on the Voiceover icon (red) opens the Voiceover toolset at the bottom of the Viewer

### Voiceover Settings

- **Audio Input:** Select which computer interface your microphone is connected to.
- **Record Track:** Select which audio track in the timeline you want the VO to be recorded to. By default, the Cut page creates a new track labeled VO, but you can manually override it to another track in this setting.
- **Monitoring:**
  - Timeline & Microphone:** Lets you hear both the timeline audio and your voice input while you're recording.
  - Timeline Audio Only:** Lets you hear the timeline audio only while you're recording.
  - Microphone Audio Only:** Lets you hear your voice input only, and mutes the timeline while you're recording.
  - Mute Monitoring When Recording:** Mutes all audio playback while you're recording. Useful to avoid audio feedback in certain recording setups without headphones.
- **No Countdown:** No visual countdown appears; when you press Record, start talking.
- **3 Secs Countdown:** Puts a three second visual countdown on the Viewer before the recording begins to allow a little time to get ready first. This is a visual cue only; there are no audio beeps.
- **5 Secs Countdown:** Puts a five second visual countdown on the Viewer before the recording begins to allow a little time to get ready first. This is a visual cue only; there are no audio beeps.
- **Voiceover Recording File Location:** Select where your new audio files are saved to.

### Script Settings

- **Enable Prompter Overlay:** Turns on or off the text overlay for the loaded script.
- **Load Script File:** Opens a file selector to choose a text file to load into the prompter.
- **Clear Script File:** Removes the text file from the prompter.
- **Font Size:** Lets you choose the font size of the on screen text.
- **Line Spacing:** Lets you choose the line spacing of the on screen text.
- **Side Margin:** Lets you choose how big of a margin to use for the on screen text.
- **Background Opacity:** Lets you choose the transparency level of the on screen text.
- **Audio Meters:** A miniature set of audio meters shows your microphone's audio levels.
- **Input Monitoring:** Click the headphone icon to toggle between hearing your microphone input while you're recording, or muting it.



- **Cue:** Snaps the playhead back to the initial record In point.
- **Record:** Starts the audio recording into the timeline.
- **Stop:** Stops the audio recording.
- **Voice Isolation:** Activates the Voice Isolation effect as you are recording to minimize any background noise.
- **Dialog Leveler:** Activates the Dialog Leveler effect as you are recording to keep a constant volume for your track.
- **Stereo Fixer:** Activates the Stereo Fixer effect as you are recording to eliminate common channel errors involved in translating between mono and stereo sources.

## ATEM Switcher Integration

If you've recorded a multi-camera event with the ATEM Mini Pro ISO or ATEM Mini Extreme ISO, it is possible to move that entire project into DaVinci Resolve. ATEM projects include the master program clip, as well as each individual camera's "ISO" (isolated) clips, and each camera angle's audio recordings. All transitions, timecode, and camera number metadata are imported, as well as whatever graphics were stored in the ATEM's Media Pool. Once the project is loaded, you can seamlessly continue your multi-camera edit in the Cut page.

This initial live recording coupled with later post-production editing workflow is often referred to as "Live to Tape." Live to Tape gives you all the benefits of the spontaneity, verisimilitude, and fast turnaround inherent to live production but with the added benefit of being able to later add and remove sections and adjust the editorial flow of the program. Live to Tape also allows you to fix simple mistakes, such as choosing a better camera angle, or replacing a title or graphic with an updated version. Because of this flexibility, Live to Tape is the preferred method of recording almost all broadcast network game shows, current events shows, and sitcoms. Essentially, any type of multi-camera production that does not primarily depend on being live in real time for its main purpose (like news or sports) is shot Live to Tape instead.

The Live to Tape workflow requires the following elements, all of which are provided by the ATEM Mini Pro ISO and ATEM Mini Extreme ISO.

- A program master clip that was shot live, including all the mixed camera angles, audio, transitions, etc. from the beginning of the show until the end, for reference.
- Separate ISO recordings from each camera used to shoot the program master clip. An ISO is an isolated (ISO) camera recording of the entire show from that camera's perspective only, from the beginning to end and without interruption.
- A timeline of the live recorded show that indicates where all the camera angles were switched, what transitions were used, and what graphics were involved.

**NOTE:** The live webcam view from the ATEM is available only on MacOS.

## Importing ATEM Mini Pro ISO Projects

Importing an ATEM project essentially rebuilds the master program clip as a timeline inside DaVinci Resolve from the camera ISOs, transitions, and graphics. This new timeline will match the master program clip in every way, just created from the original source materials rather than as a single compressed video file.

Refer to your ATEM's specific documentation for how to set up ISO recording, but one important setting is to make sure that you've checked the "ISO Record All Inputs" setting in the ATEM software control before you start shooting.

### To import an ATEM Mini Pro ISO Project:

- 1 (Before you shoot) Check the "ISO Record All Inputs" setting in the ATEM software control.
- 2 At this point, record your show using the ATEM device, and note the project's folder location.
- 3 Select File > Import Project.
- 4 Select the DaVinci Resolve Project file (.drp) in the ATEM project folder, in the file browser.
- 5 Click on the Open button.



An ATEM Mini Pro project opened in the Cut page Sync bin

## Relinking Blackmagic Camera Masters to ATEM ISOs

The ATEM records each camera's ISO as an H.264 HD video stream, which may not be of high enough resolution or quality for some purposes. It's possible to instantly switch your ATEM camera ISOs to the original camera recordings made in a Blackmagic Camera instead. This workflow enables the highest visual quality of Blackmagic RAW and the ability to output in higher resolutions (such as 4K or UHD) than are supported by the ATEM internally. Essentially, the ATEM can reference an additional set of higher quality ISOs recorded in the cameras, rather than those from the ATEM itself. This feature is only available using Blackmagic Cameras.

This workflow requires one more step in the process, namely making sure that you have sufficient recording space attached to each camera to record the show in its entirety. Refer to your ATEM's specific documentation for how to set up ISO recording and camera control, but one important setting is to make sure that you've checked the "ISO Record All Inputs" and the "Record in All Cameras" settings in the ATEM software control before you start shooting.

**To relink to Blackmagic Camera masters from ATEM ISO recordings:**

- 1 (Before you shoot) Check the “Record in All Cameras” setting in the ATEM software control.
- 2 (Before you shoot) Check the “ISO Record All Inputs” setting in the ATEM software control.
- 3 At this point, record your show using the ATEM device and note the project’s folder location.
- 4 Copy all the resulting camera masters from each camera’s memory card to the ATEM project’s “Video ISO Files” folder, and then import the project into DaVinci Resolve.
- 5 DaVinci Resolve automatically creates a separate Blackmagic RAW folder in your project and moves all the camera masters to that folder.
- 6 Use the menu Timeline > Switch to Camera Originals to instantly switch between referencing the ATEM H.264 ISOs and the Blackmagic Camera masters.

Once your project is imported successfully into DaVinci Resolve, it can be edited using the variety of specialized Multicam editing tools found in the Cut page, including the Sync Bin, Live Overwrite, and the DaVinci Resolve Speed Editor.

For more information on using these tools, see *Chapter 28, “Fast Editing in the Cut Page.”*